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Tech-savvy teachers make for tech-savvy students. Project Shiksha brings technology to the masses

Renuka Rane

A class of 50-odd students is eagerly listening to their biology teacher explain the action of photosynthesis. She uses a PowerPoint presentation with numerous images to elucidate the synthesis of compounds. Sound like a typical elite English-medium school? Well, the teacher is interacting with the students in Telugu, and the location is the Government Boys High School at Mustaidpura near Hyderabad.

The teacher, Sunita Yadav, claims that ever since she started using technology in the classroom, learning has become accelerated, more enjoyable, and more interactive for students. She says, "Earlier, I would require a mini-

um of three lectures to explain photosynthesis; now, with computers, I can do it within 20 minutes! And the students' attention is guaranteed!"

Project Shiksha

Yadav is one of the 42,000 teachers who have undergone IT training for teachers as part of Microsoft's Project Shiksha, which aims at "Empowering the future."

Project Shiksha is part of Microsoft's Partners in Learning Programme, which includes empowering students, educators, the developer community and IT professionals by providing greater access to the latest technologies and locally tailored training content.

Launched by Bill Gates, chairman and Chief Software Architect of Microsoft, during his visit to

